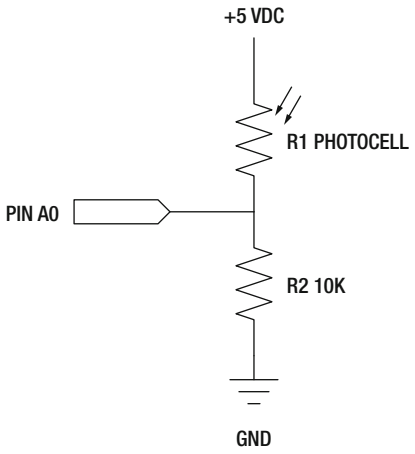

Figure 6-5. *Photocell schematic*

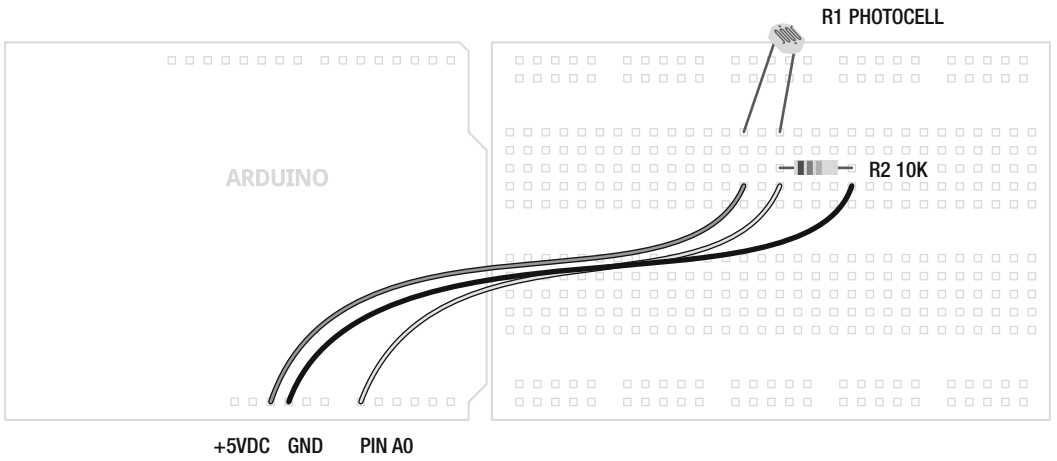

Figure 6-6. *Photocell illustration*

This schematic uses a variable resistor known as a photocell or light dependant resistor that changes its resistance based on how much or how little light reaches it. Photocells will have a maximum specified resistance for its darkness state and a minimum resistance at full light. For best results, the pull down resistor should match the maximum resistance of the photocell, although this is not mission critical. With this simple schematic wired up, we can use it to sense how light or dark it is in our environment. The question remains, how do we know what range of values our little light sensor is giving us?